



Comments received by Verra during the public comment period 27 July 2022 to 26 August 2022 of the Project ID 3324 - Ipoá REDD+ Project

Published 29 August 2022

Comment 1

Date: [Date comment submitted to Verra]

Sent by: Anonymous

Organization: Anonymous

Country: Brazil

Name: [REDACTED] - Please keep me anonymous

Country: Brazil

E-mail: [REDACTED]

Dear Verra,

My contact relates to a public comment on the IPOÁ REDD Project number 3324. I've read the rules about public comments and I want to remain anonymous. I want to declare that my comment is based on an illegality that the company developing the project is committing.

First I would like to introduce myself, my name is [REDACTED]. I work with the property management of a European family, in a family office. I develop all the work with the documentation of the properties, regularizations, obtaining licenses, managing employees, paying bills, purchasing inputs, etc. One of the properties they own is a private family reserve, which is located in Novo Aripuanã, AM.

We were approached by a representative of the company Carbonext, they proposed to us the development of a carbon credits project, having explained to me the terms and conditions proposed by them. I mentioned that my bosses' property is a private reserve area, I explained that the family's intention is to keep the area preserved, that they visit the area annually and that they never aimed to develop any type of sustainable forest management project, let alone carry out vegetation clearance.

Carbonext representative insisted that the carbon credits project is very profitable and that, even if my bosses don't want to deforest the property, the mere fact that they mention that they would intend to deforest 20% of their property, could make them have a millionaire



income, without having to do anything for it. I found the proposal extremely questionable, but as a duty, I presented it to my employers.

Immediately after hearing the proposal, my bosses were furious at Carbonext's audacity and asked me to report on the company's questionable and dishonest proposal. My bosses are knowledgeable about the carbon credits market, they are honest and upstanding, and they would never benefit from an irregular proposal, or from any illegal option, but they know that, unfortunately, many owners will accept such a proposal without thinking twice, agreeing with the illegality proposed by the company Carbonext.

The company Carbonext is motivating the property owners of native forest to commit a crime by declaring that they would have the intention to deforest a property that they had never planned to deforest, for the simple and cunning objective of obtaining a greater financial resource at the expense of a fraudulent carbon credit project, for that's why my bosses ordered me to inform the certifier Verra about the fraud that Carbonext had committed through a very dishonest proposal for a project development.

I talked to some engineers and surveyors I know who work in the Novo Aripuanã region and they informed me that many native forest property owners sought them out to request a rural activity license to cut 20% of the total native forest property, claiming that they wish to participate in a carbon credits project. The attitude of the company Carbonext is extremely unethical, fraudulent and immoral, and it is completely denigrating the appearance of legitimate carbon credit projects.

I understand that there is a term called additionality and it is clear that if people are joining the IPOÁ REDD project based on making a profit, but not based on real plans to deforest the area, then the project is not based on additionality.

Since I work in this region, I can say that most of the property owners of Novo Aripuanã municipality don't have the intention to deforest their properties due to the main fact that to cut down their forest would cost a fortune due to the high cost of logistics. Besides that, anything that they would produce would have a very high cost of logistics to sell their grains, cattle or whatever they could raise or produce on their properties. Most of the owners own land as investment and live outside of the state and most properties in this region have no security as it is not necessary.

Thanks for your attention, [REDACTED]

Comment 2

Date: 26 August 2022

Sent by: Rui Santana



Organization:

Country:

HELLO VERRA,

MY NAME IS RUI SANTANA AND I AM AN BRAZILIAN ENVIRONMENTALIST.

I DON'T KNOW WHY I AM NOT ABLE TO MAKE THIS COMMENT ON THE PUBLIC COMMENT SECTION ON YOUR WEBSITE, THE PERIOD FOR PUBLIC COMMENT FOR THE IPOÁ PROJECT IS FROM 27/07/2022 to 26/08/2022. TODAY IS AUGUST 26 AND THE COMMENT SECTION IS NOT APPEARING, WHAT IS HAPPENING?

VERRA Standards for a Sustainable Future

NEWS PUBLIC REPORT OPEN AN ACCOUNT LOGIN

The primary objective of the IPOÁ REDD+ Project is to reduce the emission of 2,809,491 tCO₂e (average of 93,650 tCO₂e/year), corresponding to 4,564 hectares of avoided deforestation over the 30-year project lifetime. IPOÁ REDD+ Project operates within private areas totaling approximately 17,386 hectares, located in the municipality of Novo Aripuanã, which ranks 15th in the ranking of deforestation of the municipalities of the Amazon biome. According to PRODES, between 2016 and 2021, an average of 160km²/year were deforested. Within the project, an estimated average of 152 ha/year of deforestation will be avoided over its lifetime. The project will generate benefits for communities and biodiversity, which are quantified and monitored according to the CCB methodological standard. The definition of strategies is carried out in a process of participatory consultation with stakeholders. The project aims to positively impact its participants immediately. For instance, programs to benefit the population including installation of communications capabilities in this remote region, distribution of sanitary products and high impact education actions are planned to initiate from the project's start. Later in the development, the feasibility of developing programs to promote the local bioeconomy will be studied, facilitating sale and increasing demand for products originating in the project area, together with the continuous conservation and maintenance of regional biodiversity.

This project was open for public comment from 27/07/2022 to 26/08/2022. Any comments received have been uploaded in the "Other Documents" section below.

Proponent
Multiple Proponents

VCS Project Status
Under development

Estimated Annual Emission Reductions
522351

VCS Project Type
Agriculture Forestry and Other Land Use

AFOLU Activity
REDD

VCS Methodology
VM0007

Acres/Hectares
17386 Hectares

Crediting Period Term
1st, 17/03/2022 - 16/03/2052

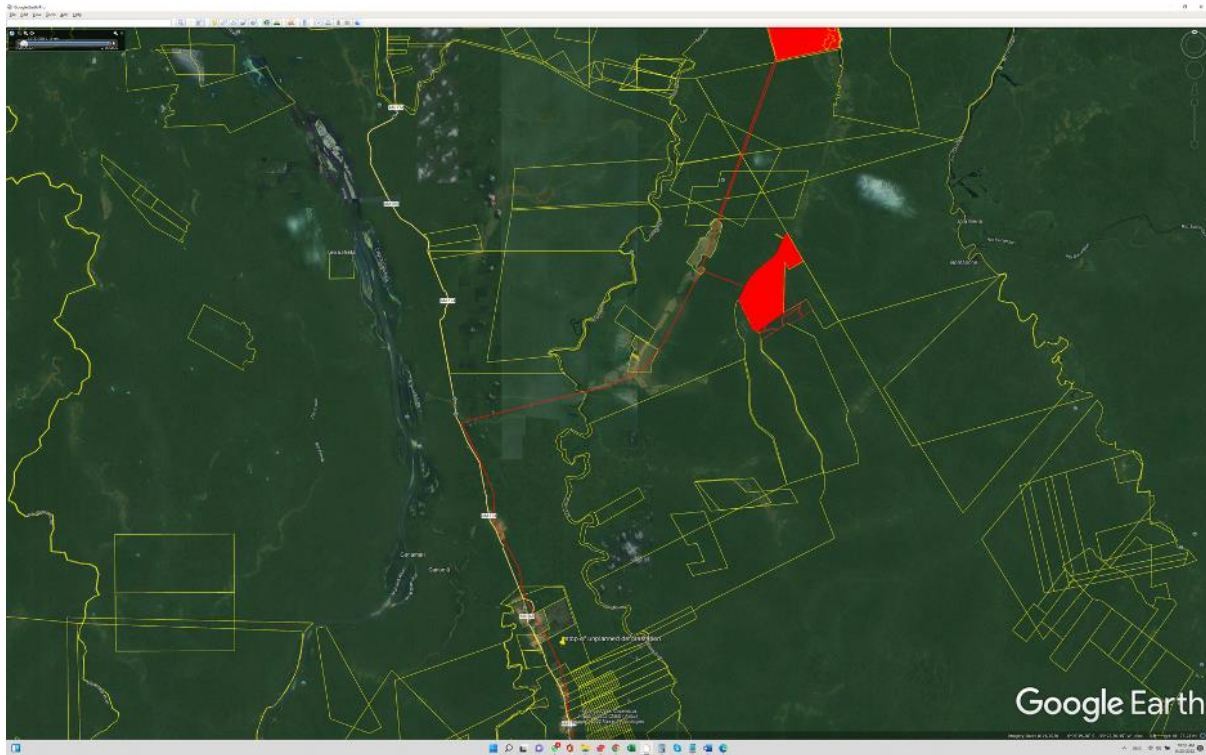
I AM MAKING MY COMMENT IN THE LAST DAY THAT IS LISTED ON YOUR WEBSITE, SO I KINDLY ASK YOU TO TAKE MY COMMENT INTO CONSIDERATION, SINCE I'M WRITING WITHIN THE PERIOD.

HERE IS MY COMMENT:

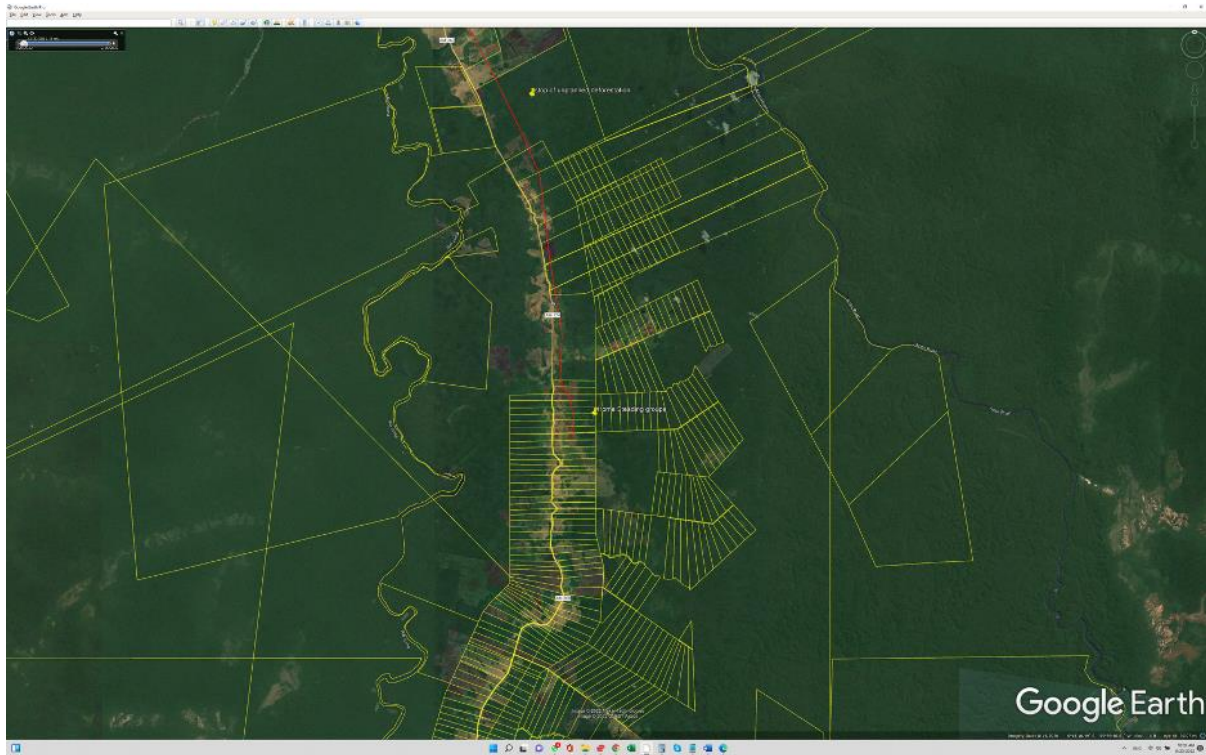
I AM AN ENVIRONMENTALIST AND I BELIEVE THAT THE IPOA PROJECT IS A TERRIBLE EXAMPLE OF A CARBON CREDIT PROJECT ON UNPLANNED DEFORESTATION.

IN THIS REGION OF NOVO ARIPUANÃ, THE DISTANCES ARE GREAT, THE ROADS ARE IN HORRIBLE CONDITIONS AND THERE IS A CONCENTRATION OF HOMESTEADS THAT ARE ABOUT 108 KM FROM THE PROJECT.

SEE MAP BELOW, THE PLOTS PAINTED ON RED IS THE PROJECT AREA, THE ARROW IS THE HOMESTEAD REGION.



IN THE MAP BELOW ARE HOMESTEADS ZOOMED IN, AND THESE HOMESTEADS ARE SLOWLY WORKING THEIR WAY INTO THE FOREST ON THE LEFT SIDE, AND MOST OF THESE LOTS ARE NOT EVEN TAKEN. THIS IS REALLY ATTRACTIVE FOR PEOPLE WHO WANT TO HAVE THEIR OWN LAND. IN THE LAST 13 YEARS, THIS REGION HAS NOT EXPANDED TOWARDS THE NORTH.



MY POINT IS, WHY WOULD SOME SQUATTER VENTURE 108 KM TO THE PROJECT AREA, WHEN THERE IS READILY AND AVAILABLE LAND FOR HOMESTEADS AND SQUATTERS NOT TOO FAR FROM THE CITY OF APUÍ?

YES, THERE IS DEFORESTATION IN THE REGION, BUT THIS DEFORESTATION IS TO THE NORTH OF THE PROJECT AREA. TO THE SOUTH OF THE PROJECT AREA NEAR APUÍ MUNICIPALITY. ALL THE DEFORESTATION IN THE AREA IS PLANNED DEFORESTATION BY A FEW LOCAL CATTLE FARMS. THERE IS NO UNPLANNED DEFORESTATION IN THIS AREA.

THE CALCULATION FOR UNPLANNED DEFORESTATION IS FAR-FETCHED, THERE IS BASICALLY NO WAY SOMEBODY IS GOING TO VENTURE 108 KM INTO THE FOREST AND INVADE THIS AREA WHEN THERE ARE AVAILABLE LANDS IN A FAR MORE CONVENIENT HOMESTEADING LOCATION.

IN TIME LAPSE MAPPING, THE HOMESTEAD LOCATION HAS NOT MOVED CLOSER TO THE PROJECT AREA ANYTIME IN THE LAST 13 YEARS. NO NEW HOMESTEAD REGION IS ANY CLOSER TO THE PROJECT. I THINK THE PROJECT CLAIMED 35 HECTARES WOULD BE DEFORESTED THIS YEAR. NOT NEXT YEAR, OR THE YEAR AFTER WITH THIS HAPPEN. FOR UNPLANNED DEFORESTATION IN THIS PROJECT, THERE IS NO WAY TO CALCULATE UNPLANNED AS THERE IS NOTHING HAPPENING FROM UNPLANNED IN THE AREA. UNTIL THE THREAT OF UNPLANNED IS CLOSER TO THE AREA, THEN A CALCULATION COULD BE DONE, BUT THE NEXT 10 YEARS THERE IS NO UNPLANNED DEFORESTATION IN THIS AREA. THE UNPLANNED CREDITS FOR THIS PROJECT IS ZERO CREDITS.



FOR THESE REASONS MORE THAN CLEARLY EXPLAINED AND PROVED, THIS PROJECT MAKES NO SENSE, IT'S PURELY DONE FOR PROFIT, AS HAS NO RISK INVOLVED AT ALL! THIS TYPE OF PROJECTS IS A SHAME FOR THE CARBON CREDITS MARKET, AS THEY ARE PURELY CREATED FOR MONETARY PURPOSES, NOT BRINGING ANY REAL BENEFIT TO THE WORLD.

THE IPOA PROJECT PEOPLE SHOULD CANCEL THE SHAME PROJECT THEY ARE DOING AND MOVE IT TO THE HOMESTEAD AREA 108 KM TO THE SOUTH. AT LEAST, THERE THEY HAVE SOME PROOF OF THREAT!

Comment 3

Date: 25 August 2022

Sent by: Fatima Souza

Organization:

Country:

To the people of Verra,

Sorry for my English, I am using a translator.

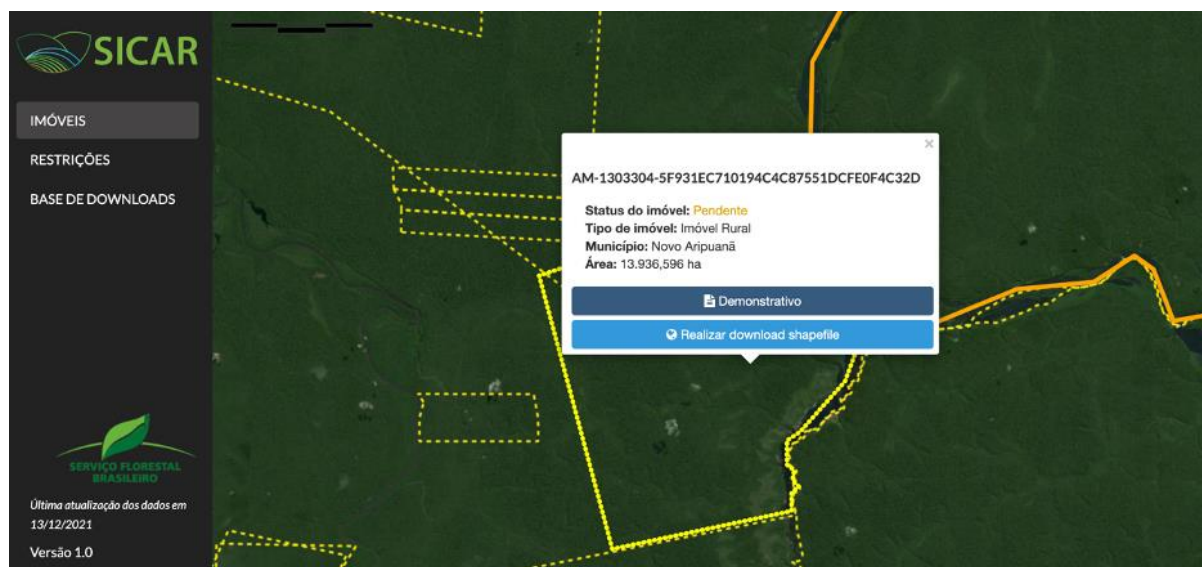
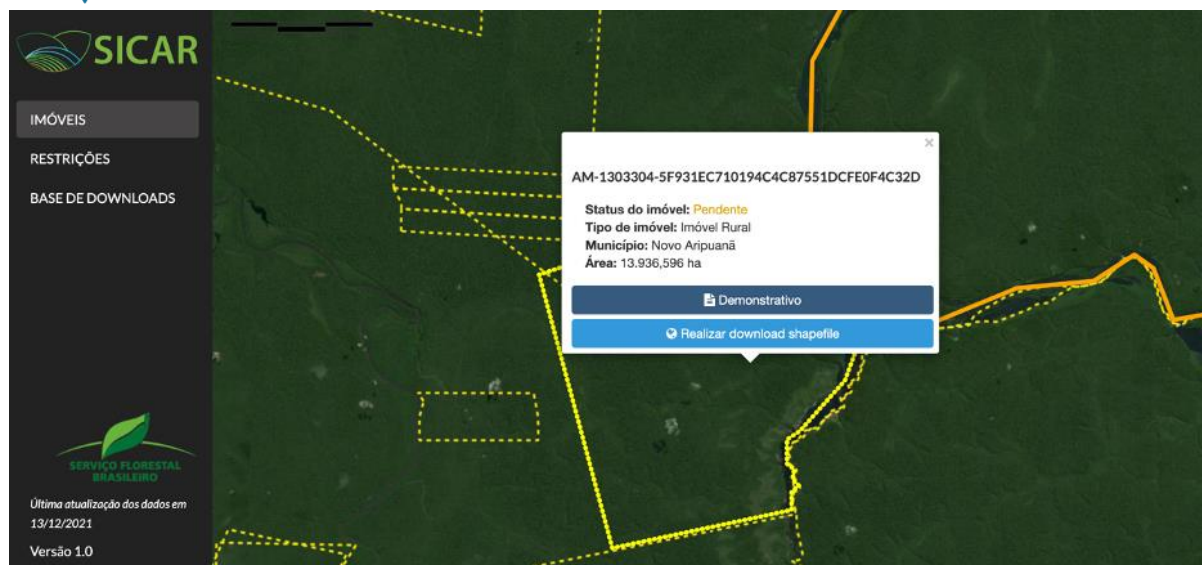
I am Fatima Souza, a Brazilian property owner and I want to make a public anonymous comment for the Ipoá Redd project.

Due to the high risk on life threatening events that have been happening among environmental people and the fact that my husband works on this industry, please keep my identity hidden, I don't want repercussions or threats from the company that is developing this project.

My husband is a survey engineer in the region near Apuí, Amazonas, a municipality near Novo Aripuanã, where is located the Ipoá Redd project and he analyzed the Ipoá REDD project documents and we have a few questions and comments about.

During the analysis time, one of the documents that got my husband's to wonder is the Cadastro Ambiental Rural – CAR (this is the environmental registration of a rural property) for the property on IPOA, that is with status “pendente” (that means pending) and not active, my husband stated that when a CAR is with pending status is because something is irregular, inconsistent, wrong or missing a information, he also said that if the Cadastro Ambiental rural is pending, then it is basically impossible to gain a deforestation license or even any type or license for cutting, including even sustainable forestry.

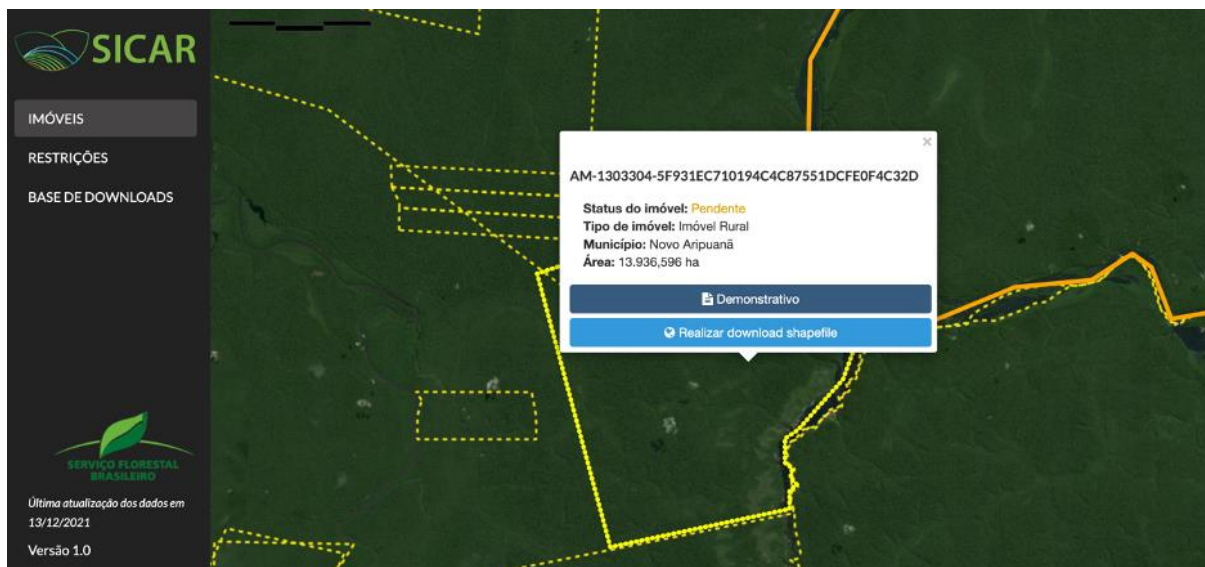
Here is the CAR on the IPOA Project, to show you that the status is pending – “pendente”:



The IPOA project was design with basis on deforestation of 20% of the properties, but still, the CAR of the property that is part of the project is with pending status, so my questions are:

1. Does the IPOA project landowners have a license for cutting - Licença Ambiental Rural (LAR)?
2. Did they added the LAR to the project documents? My husband was not able to find on the attached documents.
3. Or are they just claiming they are going to cut it down even though they don't have any of the authorizing certificates or licenses from the government?

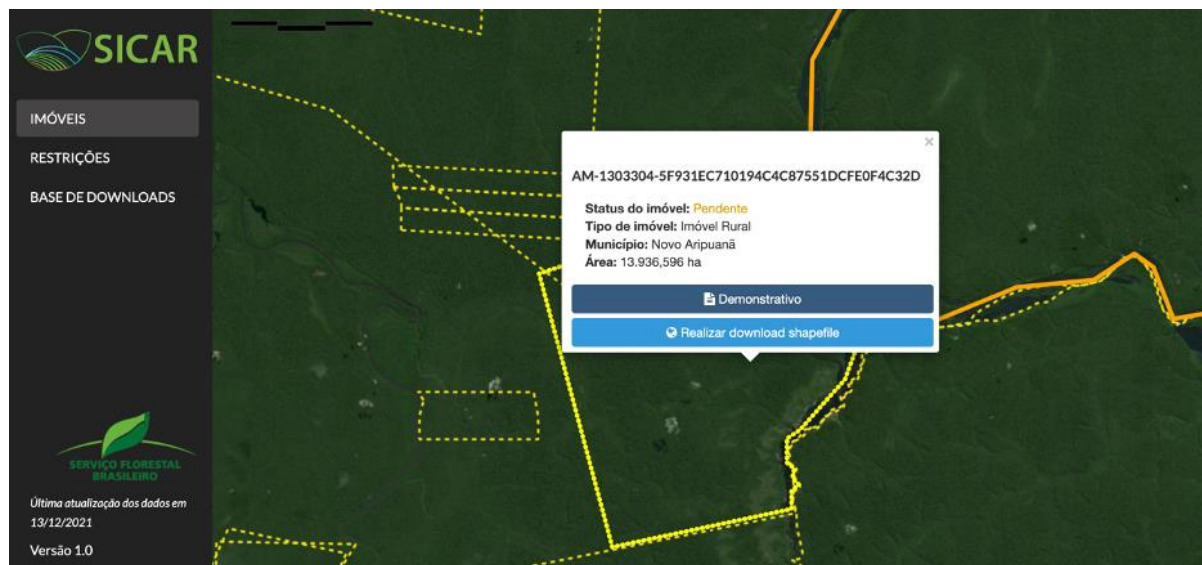
4. Is anybody able to do a project based on deforestation of 20% to gain more credits with only declaring that they had the intention to deforest 20% of their property without adding any governmental document authorizing such a deforestation project?
5. Why this project states that new properties can be added later? In the case that people do need a cutting license for the 20%, is this to give time for other landowners to be able to request a cutting license in order to enter in the Ipoá Redd project?
6. Why did the Ipoá excluded from the project areas some parts of the properties that are in the CAR and were deforested by a property owner years ago? Is that allowed? My husband analyzed the map included on the Ipoá Project and the CAR map of the property and he stated that the area added to the project is not the same area of the property line. Based on the deforestation plan they want to cut 2,706 hectares, but over 628.8 hectares is already deforested (see map below, with the deforested areas traced on yellow). If Ipoá can simply ignore what is already cut, exclude it from the project area and then claim 20% on the remaining, that would be exclusively to increase the number of generated credits. Do the auditors really care if people overestimate the number of hectares planned to be deforested in order to claim more credits?



7. The smaller property on the Ipoá project placed the planned deforestation in the area of the farm that has the higher biomass, when there are nearly 618 hectares with noticeable low forest cover. Look at the map below, my husband traced



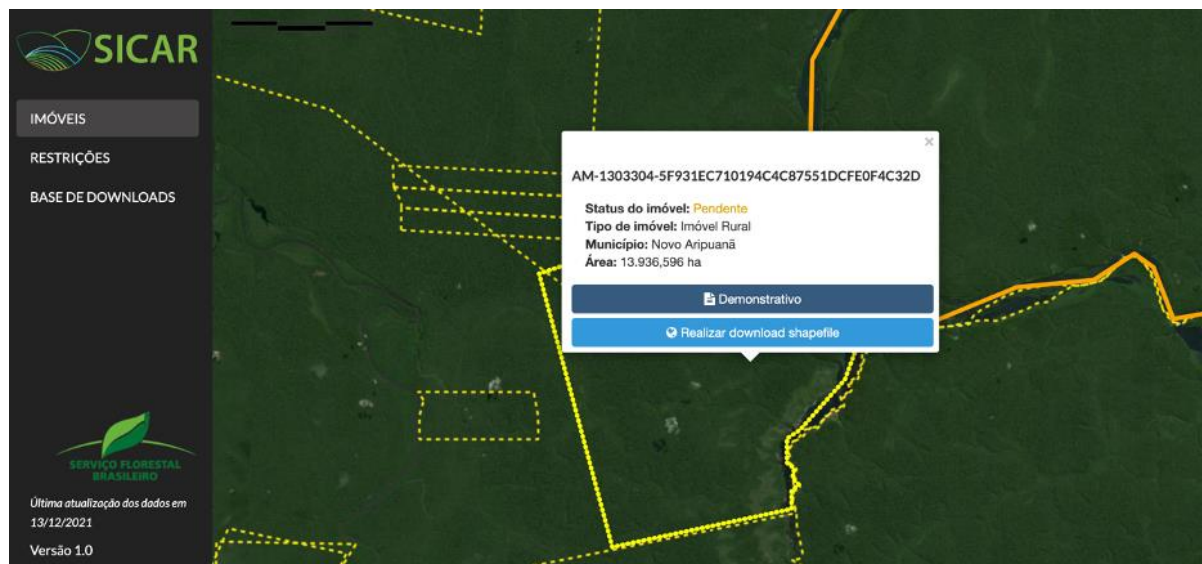
all the already deforested areas of the property, that's about 618 hectares:



Is it illegal to claim that some other part of the property will be deforested because the forest cover in that area is richer in biomass, this way a project could gain much more credits.

7. I heard that additionality is important in a project. Does Ipoá have any permanent social projects, or did they only have to show up for a few weeks to talk to the 200 or so families and then leave?

8. Here is the map of the property on the CAR system, many areas were excluded by the Ipoá project:





This is all very confusing to us, because when we hear about carbon credits projects we always thought that was all about preservation of the forest and to protect the forest against all threats that come from outsiders. But in this case of the Ipoá redd, their documentations shows that a project can be done with basis on a created threat by the own landowners of a deforestation to 20% of their forest hat would probably never happen. Is this real that a project can be done this way?

Now I have a few other questions, because my husband and I have a 5000 hectares property of forest, and we would really like to start our own carbon credit project, but our CAR is also with pending status, just like the property on the Ipoá project, so because of that we can not legally obtain a license for cutting.

So here are our questions:

1. Can we do a project only declaring that we want to open 20% of our forest and add our CAR with pending status just like Ipoá did? We don't have a cutting license.
2. If we can, about 500 tons of biomass are there on our property (my husband calculated), so according to the IPOA model, that is 500,000 credits that I can get, correct? It's a lot of money especially if we don't have to spend anything on gaining a deforestation license.
3. We have some neighbors that we already spoke, and they would be interested on joing our project, but they already deforested some areas of their property in the past. Should we add the deforested areas to the project or is better for the project if we do like Ipoá project did and just don't add the deforested parts on the project and do the 20% of intention to cut on the forested part? We already have 250 deforested, so instead of claiming credits on only 250 that would be deforested, can we just state we will cut 500 and exclude that 250 from the project map? It will take some personal visits with the people from the government to get the license, but we can tell them the 250 already deforested is abandoned so it will grow back and we get the new license for 500.
4. Do we need to add a cutting license for the 20% of planned deforestation? If we do, it will take some time to get, so can we start the project and add the license later? Like I said, my husband is a forestry engineer so he can do the work, but we are really in need of an income so it would be great to know if we can add the license later and start the project now, so we can start getting and selling credits right away.

Please provide me the information and steps and also please let me know if IPOA did it without the license for cutting, so I can prepare



all my documents and start working on my project as soon as possible. If I don't need the license for cutting, I can start my project right away. Thank you so much.

Fatima S.

Sent with [Proton Mail](#) secure email.

Comment 4

Date:

Sent by: [REDACTED]

Organization:

Country:

Dear Verra,

My contact relates to a public comment on the IPOÁ REDD Project number 3324. I've read the rules about public comments and I want to remain anonymous. I want to declare that my comment is based on an illegality that the company developing the project is committing.

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We were approached by a representative of the company Carbonext, they proposed to us the development of a carbon credits project, having explained to me the terms and conditions proposed by them. I mentioned that my bosses' property is a private reserve area, I explained that the family's intention is to keep the area preserved, that they visit the area annually and that they never aimed to develop any type of sustainable forest management project, let alone carry out vegetation clearance.

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they would never benefit from an irregular proposal, or from any illegality option, but they know that unfortunately many owners will accept such a proposal without thinking twice, agreeing with the illegality proposed by the company Carbonext.

The company Carbonext is motivating the property owners of native forest to commit a crime by declaring that they would have the intention to deforest a property that they had never planned to deforest, for the simple and cunning objective of obtaining a greater financial resource at the expense of a fraudulent carbon credit project, for that's why my bosses ordered me to inform the certifier Verra about the fraud that Carbonext had committed through a very dishonest proposal for a project development.

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I understand that there is a term called additionality and it is clear that if people are joining the IPOÁ REDD project based on making a profit, but not based on real plans to deforest the area, then the project is not based on additionality.

Since I work in this region, I can say that most of the property owners of Novo Aripuanã municipality don't have the intention to deforest their properties due to the main fact that to cut down their forest would cost a fortune due to the high cost of logistics. Besides that, anything that they would produce would have a very high cost of logistics to sell their grains, cattle or whatever they could raise or produce on their properties. Most of the owners own land as investment and live outside of the state and most properties in this region have no security as it is not necessary.

Thanks for your attention, [REDACTED]

Comment 5

Date: 26 August 2022

Sent by: Victor Ferraz

Organization: The Nature-based Solutions Brazil Alliance

Submitted to: Verra

Project under public consultation: IPOÁ REDD+ Project (ID 3324)



Public consultation response IPOÁ REDD+ Project

The Nature-based Solutions Brazil Alliance aims to promote and stimulate an agenda to discourage deforestation and forest degradation through the creation of guidelines and good practices, generating a safe and reliable business environment. The NBS Brazil Alliance appreciates this opportunity to share input on the Arca REDD+ Project. The open consultation process and the possibility to participate actively is an opportunity to improve the integrity of the carbon credits.

As a non-profit association of project developers whose members are: Agrocortex, Bioassets, Biofílica, BR Carbon, BVRio, Carbonext, Ecosecurities, ERA Brazil, FAS, IDESAM, Instituto Ekos Brasil, Mirova Natural Capital – Althelia Funds, Permian and South Pole, it is great to see new carbon projects being developed.

The following aspects contained within the Project Description were seen as concerns:

Methodology and Baseline

The area seems eligible for REDD+ projects. The DP does not make it clear how it defined the project area respecting the conditions of application of the methodology and applicable modules, which areas were excluded from the project area either because they do not constitute forest, or because they are not legally deforestable (APP, areas with a slope greater than 45 degrees, etc.). On the contrary, the project baseline is based on cutting 20% of the existing forest cover, but this is not technically possible (EX.: "The APD component is regarding a 3.595,72 ha subsection (20%) of the Maanaim and Campos property, which has documented forest clearing plans"). The combination of AUD and APD activities appears to increase the deforestation rate and a deforestation risk supported exclusively by a clear-cut permit of 20% in five years in the absence of the project.

Even though the baseline scenario seems plausible in the context in which the project is developed, the PD does not provide enough information to allow the reader to reconstruct the baseline analysis and estimates. The DP does not present how the methodology steps were followed in order to define the APD baseline, does not present all the relevant formulas, and does not show how data were used to generate estimates. Also, there is a lack of analysis of proxy areas or financial viability conditions to demonstrate the possibility of planned deforestation in the project area and zone.



Regarding the project start date, the proponent states that APD activities started in May 2022, when the project owner submitted a request to the official organ, IPAAM, to obtain permission to deforest the legal proportion of the project area. However, the Local Stakeholder Consultation (LSC) was conducted before, in March. The proponent



should explain why legal deforestation's intention appeared just after the LSC, if it was never considered (or requested to the local authority).

Ownership (VCS)/Legal Status and Property Rights (CCB)

The Campos Farm has a title issued by the municipality of Novo Aripuanã over a State Gleba, which is a strong indication of irregularities. The property registration number appears to belong to two different applicants. See evidence consulted below:

Local Stakeholder Consultation (VCS)/Free, Prior and Informed Consent (CCB)

The FPIC process appears very poorly described in the PD and is not sufficient evidence of social safeguarding. The PD actually advocates that the FPIC process is not applicable.

Other comments

Some of the points presented above have already been clarified by Carbonext. It was mentioned that the other points will be corrected / addressed in the Post-draft.

Código do(a) Credenciado(a)

Código do Vértice

Código do Imóvel (SNCR/INCRA)

9510301381698

Credenciado(a) responsável técnico(a) pela parcela

Código de um dos vértices que compõe a parcela

Código SNCR do imóvel

Pesquisar

Resultados: 2

Nome	Área (ha)	Detentor(a)	CNS	Matrícula	Ações
Fazenda Campos - Parcela 1	4796,0277	XXXXXX de Oliveira XXXXXX	00.477-0	2.584	
Fazenda Grupo Leão - Gleba 04 - Parte 1	57124,5958	XXXXXXo Matias daXXXXXX	00.477-0	1818	

Mensagens

Remetente	Mensagem	Data
ANDERSON DE OLIVEIRA ALEXANDRE	Boa tarde Senhores, estou aguardando o informe de registro. Se for preciso alguma documentação adicional, peço que me informem por aqui para que eu envie.	12/12/2018
Analista (INCRA SR-15)	Analista (INCRA SR-15) De acordo com a solicitação do requerente, tenho a solicitar alguns documentos para a validação do Registro: a) Certidão de Inteiro Teor atualizado do Estado, pois como é Título do Município e esta fora da área de atuação da mesma, a SPF tem conhecimento, pois trata-se de TD com o reconhecimento do estado. b) Atender o Memo Circular Nº 14/DF/INCRA, onde esclarecer sobre a atualização cadastral (espelho atualizado da parcela onde consta todas as informações)	11/01/2019
ANDERSON DE OLIVEIRA ALEXANDRE	Solicito nova análise do requerimento de informação de registro da atualização da matrícula em cartório. Solicito ainda, alteração da Matrícula atual para a atualizada 2.819 do mesmo CRI. Documentos solicitados no anexo.	29/01/2019
	% Anexos Nova Matrícula Faz Campos Matrícula 2.819 matricula-faz-campos.pdf	

NBS BRAZIL ALLIANCE
NATURE BASED SOLUTIONS



The NBS Brazil Alliance appreciates this important opportunity to record our comments. We welcome the project proponents to reach-out directly with any questions or follow-up requests related to the comments shared above by contacting **NBS Brazil Alliance Coordinator, Victor Ferraz**, at **nbs@nbsbrazilalliance.com**.